CORE FALSE BELIEF #9 · OTHER PEOPLE

“People will leave me.”

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Where it often comes from

Fear of being left often begins with real loss: a parent who left, died, or was emotionally absent; a divorce; repeated moves; or a partner who walked away. A child may conclude that people always leave, and that it must be because of something in them. As adults, people with this fear may cling tightly, test others, or avoid closeness altogether, and these patterns can sometimes bring about the very loss they fear.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that people do leave, die, and fail us. David even wrote of being forsaken by father and mother. But God promises He will never leave or forsake His people. Isaiah says that even if a mother could forget her nursing child, God will not forget you. Jesus promised not to leave His followers as orphans. Human relationships are precious and uncertain, but there is One who will never walk away. That security can free us to love others without clinging or running.

> *“Be strong and courageous; do not be afraid or terrified of them, for it is the LORD your God who goes with you; He will never leave you nor forsake you”* (Deuteronomy 31:6).

Also see

> “Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: ‘Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.’” (Hebrews 13:5).

> “Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me” (Psalm 27:10).

> “‘Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you!’” (Isaiah 49:15).

> “I will not leave you as orphans; I will come to you” (John 14:18).

Common self-statements

- Everyone I love eventually leaves.
- It’s only a matter of time.
- If I let someone close, they’ll abandon me.
- I have to keep people happy or they’ll go.
- I’m easy to walk away from.
- I can’t survive being left again.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will leave without evidence.
- Overgeneralization: Believing that because some people left, everyone will.
- Personalization: Assuming people left because something is wrong with me.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining that being left would be unbearable and endless.

Challenging questions

- Who left me in the past, and what were the real reasons?

- Who has stayed in my life, even through hard times?
- Am I clinging, testing, or pulling away to protect myself?
- What evidence do I have that this person will leave?
- What does God promise about His presence?
- How could I love more freely if I trusted God's presence?

Truth summary

> Some people have left me, and that was painful. But not everyone leaves, and God never will. He has promised to be with me always. I can love people without clinging or running, because my deepest security is in the One who stays.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- God, Present Everywhere
- Trust
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People will leave me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People will leave me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who left me, and why?
- ☐ Who has stayed?
- ☐ Am I clinging, testing, or pulling away?
- ☐ What evidence says this person will leave?
- ☐ What does God promise about His presence?
- ☐ How could I love more freely?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God will never leave or forsake me.
- ☐ God will not forget me.
- ☐ Not everyone leaves.
- ☐ My past losses do not predict every future.
- ☐ I can love without clinging.
- ☐ Jesus will not leave me an orphan.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Deuteronomy 31:6**
  "Be strong and courageous; do not be afraid or terrified of them, for it is the LORD your God who goes with you; He will never leave you nor forsake you."
- ☐ **Isaiah 49:15**
  "'Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you!'"
- ☐ **Psalm 27:10**
  "Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Who stayed today: Each evening, write the names of people who showed up for you today, in large or small ways.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Deuteronomy 31:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord goes with me. He will never leave me or forsake me.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "God, Present Everywhere" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ List the people who stayed. Write the names of people who have stayed in your life through hard times. Thank God for each one.
- ☐ Notice the test. When you are tempted to test someone's loyalty, pause and instead tell them honestly what you need.
- ☐ Practice letting go a little. Give someone space this week without texting or checking in excessively. Notice what happens.
- ☐ Rest in God's promise. Write Deuteronomy 31:6 on a card and read it whenever you fear being left.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “People will leave me”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Someone who stayed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People will leave me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am afraid of losing the people I love. Thank You that You will never leave me or forsake me. Heal the wounds from those who left, help me love without clinging, and let me rest in Your faithful presence. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.